

1.3 Satisfiability

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11:49 AM

Definition: A compound proposition is satisfiable if you can assign truth values which make it (T) true. Otherwise it is unsatisfiable.

Can I assign a truth value to p to make $p \vee \neg p$ true?
what about $p \wedge \neg p$?

Consider $\neg(r \wedge p) \vee (q \oplus p) \vee (\neg r \wedge q)$

To be (T) true, we need at least one piece to be true.

$$\begin{aligned} \neg(r \wedge p) &\stackrel{?}{=} \text{True} & q \oplus p &\stackrel{?}{=} \text{True} \\ \Rightarrow r \wedge p &\equiv \text{False} & \Rightarrow q = \text{True}, p = \text{False} \\ \Rightarrow \boxed{r = \text{False}, p = \text{False}} & & \text{or} \\ & & \boxed{q = \text{False}, p = \text{False}} \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \neg r \wedge q &\equiv \text{True} \\ \Rightarrow \neg r = \text{True}, q = \text{True} \\ \Rightarrow \boxed{r = \text{False}, q = \text{True}} \end{aligned}$$

Then we can choose any of these as long as we make it complete.

The assignment $p = \text{False}, q = \text{True}, r = \text{False}$ makes the compound prop. (T) true hence it is satisfiable.

If the original problem used conjunction instead

" $\neg(r \wedge p) \wedge (q \oplus p) \wedge (\neg r \wedge q)$ "

we would need to do more.

Requires each piece to be (T) true now.

Requires each piece to be

(T) rue now.

Split into 4 teams.

Are the following satisfiable?

If so, what truth values work?

If not, explain why.

1. $(p \vee \neg g) \wedge (g \vee \neg r) \wedge (r \vee \neg p)$

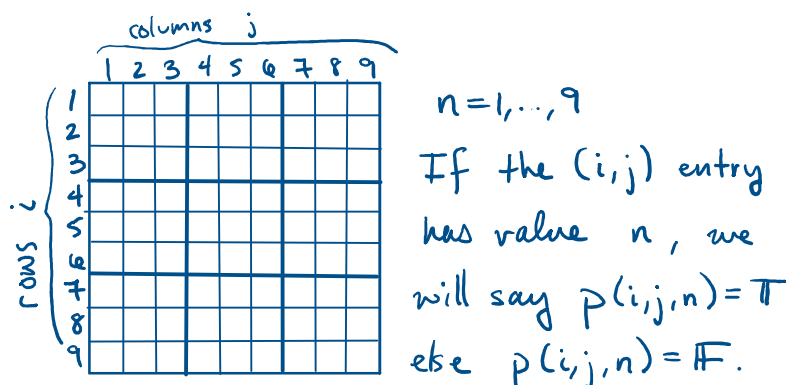
2. $(p \vee g \vee r) \wedge (\neg p \vee \neg g \vee \neg r)$

3. $(p \vee \neg g) \wedge (g \vee \neg r) \wedge (r \vee \neg p) \wedge (p \vee g \vee r)$

Satisfiability has applications in a wide variety of studies. In particular, it is used in programs which make and solve puzzles.

The book gives a really nice description and story for the n -Queens Problem as well as Sudoku.

For Sudoku we know we want 1, ..., 9 in each row column and 3×3 box without duplicates. We can encode this using compound propositions!



Verifying row 1 contains the number 3
 can be done by checking if

$$p(1,1,3) \vee p(1,2,3) \vee \dots \vee p(1,9,3)$$

 is satisfiable.

Remember, this can be shortened

$$\bigvee_{j=1}^9 p(1,j,3)$$

To make sure each number appears

$$\left(\bigvee_{j=1}^9 p(1,j,1) \right) \wedge \left(\bigvee_{j=1}^9 p(1,j,2) \right) \wedge \dots \wedge \left(\bigvee_{j=1}^9 p(1,j,9) \right)$$

Since we want all of them to appear, we
 need conjunction.

This simplifies to...

$$\bigwedge_{n=1}^9 \bigvee_{j=1}^9 p(1,j,n)$$

So then to make sure every row contains
 every number, we form another conjunction
 over all the rows.

$$\bigwedge_{i=1}^9 \bigwedge_{j=1}^9 \bigvee_{n=1}^9 p(i,j,n)$$

This process is then done for
 checking all the columns and
 all the boxes.

Then with careful way of
 encoding a sudoku puzzle,
 we ask the program to solve
 the satisfiability problem
 which in turn solves the
 sudoku.